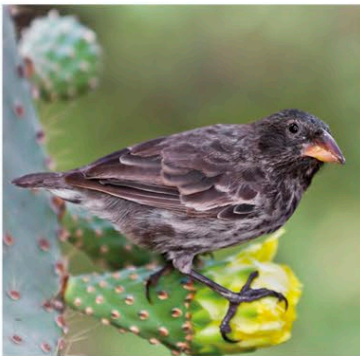


Geologically, the Galápagos are **young islands**, the **oldest** having emerged just **4.2 million years ago**



△ **SPECIALIZED BILL**
The common cactus finch uses its specially adapted bill to feed on the pollen, nectar, fruit, and seeds of *Opuntia* cacti.

◁ **GIGANTIC CALDERA**
The Sierra Negra volcano is one of six volcanoes that formed Isabela Island. Five are still active, including Sierra Negra, which has an elliptical caldera.

GALÁPAGOS VEGETATION ZONES

On the Galápagos, rainfall generally increases with altitude, creating three main vegetation zones. The arid zone harbors cacti and other drought-resistant plants. On larger islands, small trees and shrubs dominate the higher transition zone, before giving way to lush forests in the humid zone.

KEY
Arid Transition Humid

▽ **VOLCANIC ISLET**
One of the archipelago's youngest islands, Bartolomé Island off the coast of Santiago is home to a breeding colony of Galápagos penguin, the world's second smallest penguin species.

